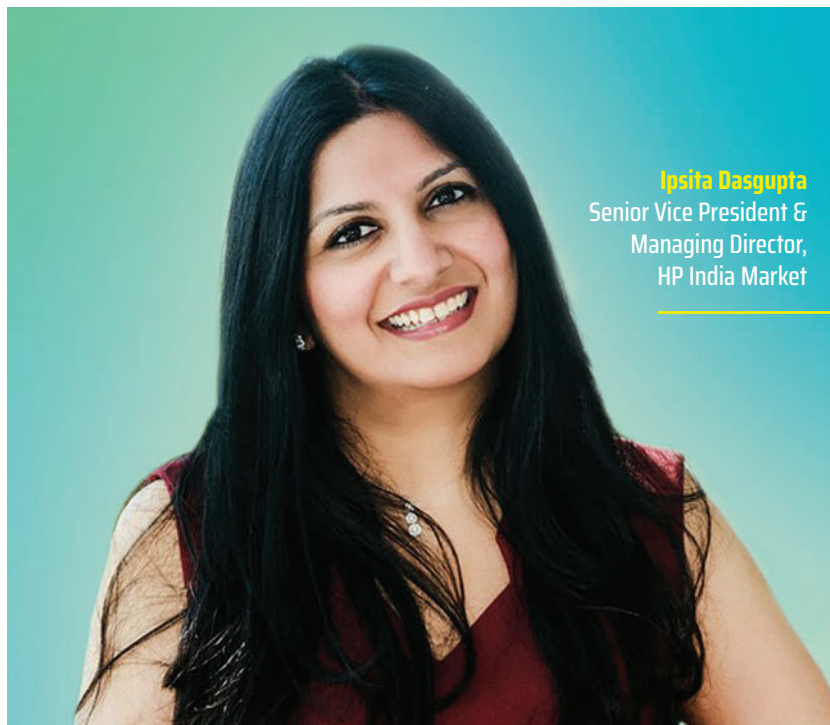




Ipsita Dasgupta
Senior Vice President &
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HP India's Ipsita Dasgupta on Women in Tech, AI and Gaming's new frontiers

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In a world where technology is reshaping our lives at warp speed, the story of women's ascent in this domain continues to inspire. Ipsita Dasgupta, Senior Vice President & Managing Director, HP India Market, stands at the forefront of this evolution, championing not just technological innovation but a profound cultural shift towards inclusivity and diversity. Reflecting on the representation and participation of women in technology, Dasgupta acknowledges the strides made but underscores the journey ahead. "We are moving in the right direction as far as women's

participation in the technology sector is concerned but we have a long way to go," she states, emphasising the critical need for accelerated change in India's workforce dynamics.

With a robust background spanning over two decades in strategic business roles across global giants like Apple, General Electric, and now HP, Dasgupta brings a nuanced understanding of what it takes to navigate and reshape the tech world. On the eve of International Women's Day, Digit sat down with Dasgupta to discuss her journey, the evolving role of women in technology, and the future of gaming and AI that HP India is helping spearhead. Edited interview excerpts follow:

Q How is HP India working towards creating a more inclusive environment for women in the technology sector?

A One of our key strategies has been to focus on hiring, retaining, and investing in women. Women now make up one-third of our workforce, and this number used to be in the low double digits not too long ago. Key to our success has been our intentional hiring practices and our step-up program, which aims to match internal talent with open positions. We believe that diversity at all levels, especially in P&L roles, brings enormous value to the business. But we still need to help nudge women into these roles; to achieve this, our 'Disha' initiative, focuses on enhancing leadership skills for high-potential women, enabling them to advance in their careers. Notably, at HP India, our Product teams for Printing Systems, Gaming, and Sales are all led by women.

Q As a leader, mother, and advocate for women in technology, how do you manage these roles?

A I don't believe there is a way to balance these roles. I let my work and personal lives blend into each other in as natural a way as possible. Many times in my career, I have had to bring my children to work, and many times I have had to pull in my family members to look after my children when I've had to take care of an emergent business need. Both men and women have enormous personal challenges, and yet still show up to take on professional roles that are demanding. This is only possible if our social structure supports us and our ability to do both and our professional environments acknowledge that our personal commitments exist. It is true that men still get more support than women do from their personal ecosystems to pursue a career. But we need to change this. I am lucky that I have extremely supportive parents, an extremely supportive spouse, and children who engage with excitement in my desire to make an impact professionally. I also always point out that I experience at least a dozen